



FORTUNA ADMISSIONS
INSIDER'S TOP TIPS
FOR APPLYING TO
NYU STERN

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ABOUT THE SCHOOL

Much like New York itself, NYU Stern has changed a lot over the years. Though the Columbia Business School may disagree, Stern is the business school of Wall Street, and was even located near Wall Street until the early nineties. The main campus is now in Greenwich Village, home to Silicon Alley with the second highest concentration of Internet startups in the U.S. after Silicon Valley. It is also one of the world's centers for artistic creation, and it is no surprise that the school has such strong ties with the fashion industry, luxury brands, and the world of entertainment and media.

With faculty that include Professor of Economics Nouriel Roubini, who anticipated the collapse of the U.S. housing market and worldwide recession, Stern's influence extends from Wall Street to Main Street. The school has some of the best finance professors in the world, and a constant stream of influential guest speakers.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

Finance, Accounting, Entertainment Media and Technology, Luxury, Marketing, Real Estate, Strategy, Big Data, Entrepreneurship

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants: 3,781 MBA Class Size: 370
Admissions Selectivity: 23% Yield: 42.55%
Total Tuition: \$143,352

POST-MBA CAREERS

Sector: Finance 33.8%, Consulting 28.4%, Tech 16.5%; Consumer products 5.2%,
Top Recruiters: Amazon, Credit Suisse, McKinsey, IBM, JP Morgan, Bain, Deloitte, Goldman
Avg. Base Salary: \$121,146 Employment in 3 months: 95.4%

MBA RANKINGS

	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	16	-	22	24	17	18	13	13
Financial Times	10	12	10	10	10	11	13	13
Forbes	-	23	-	18	-	21	-	20
The Economist	9	6	6	9	14	14	15	14
US News	11	10	10	11	20	12	13	12

ADMISSIONS

Avg. Age: 28 yrs Avg. GMAT: 716 Avg. GPA: 3.45
Int'l Students: 39% Female Students: 35%

Deadlines for 2019-2020 (fulltime MBA):
R1 - Oct 15, '19
R2 - Nov 15, '19
R3 - Jan 15, '20
R4 - Mar 15, '20

Fashion & Luxury MBA
R1 - Sept 15, '19
R2 - Nov 15, '19
R3 - Jan 15, '20
R4 - Feb 15, '20

Sources: NYU Stern, BusinessWeek, Financial Times, US News, MBA50



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ESSAYS 2019-2020:

Essay 1: Professional Aspirations

(500 word maximum, double-spaced, 12-point font)

- What are your short and long-term career goals?
- How will the MBA help you achieve them?

Essay 2: Personal Expression (a.k.a. "Pick Six")

Describe yourself to the Admissions Committee and to your future classmates using six images and corresponding captions. Your uploaded PDF should contain all of the following elements:

- A brief introduction or overview of your "Pick Six" (no more than 3 sentences).
- Six images that help illustrate who you are.
- A one-sentence caption for each of the six images that helps explain why they were selected and are significant to you.

Note: Your visuals may include photos, infographics, drawings, or any other images that best describe you. Your document must be uploaded as a single PDF. The essay cannot be sent in physical form or be linked to a website.

Essay 3: Additional Information (optional)

(250 word maximum, double-spaced, 12-point font)

Please provide any additional information that you would like to bring to the attention of the Admissions Committee. This may include current or past gaps in employment, further explanation of your undergraduate record or self-reported academic transcript(s), plans to retake the GMAT, GRE, IELTS or TOEFL, or any other relevant information.



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Tip #1 - Demonstrating your IQ + EQ

Stern is proud of its reputation as a program that develops students who are not only smart but also have interpersonal strengths and teamwork skills. It's not enough to just have strong grades and GMAT scores since Stern is looking for prospective students who will be involved in the school community and who are team players. The Admissions Committee uses a holistic approach to evaluate applicants, which includes evaluating individuals' academic and professional backgrounds as well as personal characteristics. Stern looks for candidates who are team-oriented and have strong leadership potential.

You will have a number of opportunities to demonstrate your EQ and IQ, through your essays, interview and campus visit, as well as the EQ endorsement—a testimonial provided by an advocate that illustrates a specific example of demonstrated EQ. Unlike your professional recommendations, you are not restricted to choosing someone from your professional life; your only restriction is that it cannot be a family member. They are looking for a richer and deeper understanding of who you are through this endorsement, so you should choose someone who knows you extremely well and can be a powerful and compelling advocate of your EQ. Your endorser should have multiple examples to draw from that display your self-awareness, empathy, communication skills and self-management. Resist the inclination to get hung up the person's title or position. This is about who knows you best and who can communicate your strengths most strongly.

Tip #2 - Academic strengths beyond finance

As a top-ranked business school in NYC it's no surprise that Stern is world-renowned for its strength in finance but it is also strong in a number of other disciplines. Don't be concerned if you have never taken a finance class or if you work in an unrelated industry. The Stern Admissions Committee values diversity and looks for candidates from many different backgrounds. In addition to finance, recruiters from NYC and other parts of the country (and world!) recruit at Stern each year for positions in consulting, marketing, management, operations, strategic planning, real estate, social enterprise, and more. You'll find well-known faculty teaching in these disciplines and because of its location in NYC, Stern is able to get incredible real-world practitioners as guest speakers and to teach courses.

Stern is also highly regarded for its strengths in entertainment, media and technology (EMT) and hosts impressive conferences with well-known and accomplished individuals in the EMT industry. Anyone interested in entrepreneurship should look into Stern's Berkley Center for Entrepreneurship and Innovation and consider entering one of the annual business plan competitions.

Tip #3 - Understanding the NYU Stern difference

From the moment you set foot on campus, you'll be able to feel what it's like to be an MBA student at Stern. Students and faculty are approachable and collaborative and many professors make themselves available to students after classes end. One popular professor for a Negotiations class provides his students with a lifelong promise to be available for advice on matters like negotiating a real estate transaction or job offer. The best way to experience the Stern difference is to visit the campus in person, meet students, and observe a class in session to determine if the school is a good fit for you.

It is obvious when reading an application whether a candidate has done his or her homework on the program. Make sure you incorporate information about Stern that's relevant to your



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candidacy. You have an opportunity to convince the Adcom why Stern is the right school for you and specific examples are a good way to show you have spent the time to research the program. There are many tools available to better know Stern including the program website and the school's social media outlets.

Tip #4 - Selecting the best recommenders

When thinking about who should write your letters of recommendation, select individuals who know you well and who can provide in-depth detail about your work performance and personal characteristics. Stern prefers a recommender who you have worked with closely over someone else with an important title who does not know you as well. Your manager or other superior who oversees your performance is often the best option but if for some reason this isn't possible, use your discretion and select recommenders with whom you have a strong professional relationship. Avoid asking for recommendations from personal friends or family members.

Tip #5 - Adcom's view of non-traditional backgrounds

Stern strongly believes in the benefit of a well-rounded, diverse student body and there are a number of Stern students with non-traditional backgrounds. In a block of first year students (of approximately 60) you will likely find individuals with backgrounds in teaching, non-profit, sales, healthcare, and more (in addition to students with more traditional backgrounds in finance, consulting, marketing, etc). Having a diverse student body makes class discussions more interesting and allows for valuable input and insights when working on team projects.

Stern also provides opportunities for anyone with a non-traditional background or who has been out of school for a while to get a jump-start on business school to ensure a seamless transition. Through the Summer Start program at Stern, a group of incoming students participate in a six-week program that involves academic, leadership, and individual development activities.

Tip #6 - Value of extracurricular activities

At Stern it's not just about your grades and GMAT, but also your personal characteristics and qualities and what you will bring to the Stern community. A big part of the Stern experience involves extracurricular activities, which include professional groups as well as recreational clubs. MBA students run the campus clubs and they're looking for the next generation of leaders in each incoming class. Whether you have a talent in music or sports or just have a desire to learn something new, the Adcom is interested in hearing what you can contribute to the Stern community.

Spend time looking into the clubs online and think about how you see yourself getting involved. Consider what kind of involvement you'd like to have with different campus organizations. Realistically you won't be able to participate in every event that takes place on campus so prioritize which organizations will be the most important for you. Many students join a few professional clubs as well as community and sports/social clubs but take on significant leadership roles in one or two.

Tip #7 - Addressing weaknesses in your application

Take a look at Stern's latest class profile – if you fall below the middle 80% range in GMAT or undergraduate GPA you can take steps to address your concerns. For someone with a limited number of quantitative classes on your resume or poor undergraduate grades, consider taking a quantitative class like calculus, statistics, economics, or even accounting at a local accredited



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college or continuing education program. You can also think about taking on analytical projects at your job to show your strength in this area. In addition to considering a candidate's academic and professional background in the admissions process, Stern places a strong emphasis on personal characteristics. If you are weaker in one area hopefully you can find a way to show strengths in another area.

Tip #8 – Writing your Stern essays

When the time comes to writing your essays, think of this as an opportunity for the Adcom to get a deeper insight into what makes you tick and what will make you a great asset to Stern. This is your chance to convey information that isn't covered anywhere else in the application. While the first essay is pretty standard, asking about your professional aspirations, the second, a creative essay, is not as common. Stern specifies the use of images, which gives you a firm starting point for expressing yourself (in past years, the question was much more open-ended, inviting candidates to use "almost any method" to convey their message, and many candidates didn't know where to start.) Know that Stern values individuality, so think about the range of images that can offer more insight into who you are. Just make sure that what you submit has meaning and answers the question.

Tip #9 – Presenting your career aspirations

When working on your application, it's important that you have a good idea about the career you envision for yourself after business school. Even if you are not 100% certain, have a few ideas of the kinds of roles that you are interested in and be able to show why they would be a good choice based on your background and skills. Spend time in advance of applying to do your research and speak to current business school students and alumni to learn more about what kind of career opportunities are available to Stern business school graduates. Be prepared to think of a backup plan if something changes and you don't get the coveted job you are hoping for. Stern has great success rates for placing graduates in jobs so take a look at Stern's MBA career section online to be knowledgeable about the most common industries and companies for recent graduates.

Tip #10 – Timing for submitting your application

You don't want to wait until the last minute to get all of the pieces of your application ready. If possible, start early and take the time to do your research before writing your essays. This can help you with the content of what you write about. Don't worry if you can't get your application ready in time for the first application deadline. It's more important that you do what it takes to make your application as strong as possible. However, be aware that waiting to apply until the last deadline means not as many spots are available. You should also check with Admissions to see by when you need to apply to be considered for certain scholarships or to be eligible to attend admitted student events. International students will also need more time to work out visa arrangements so consider applying by the first or second deadline.

More about Fortuna Admissions:

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

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